

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 10: MY GRANDMOTHER'S HOUSE (BY KAMALA DAS)

CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"My Grandmother's House" is a deeply emotional and autobiographical poem by Kamala Das. She fondly remembers her childhood home where she received pure, unconditional love from her grandmother. Now, after her grandmother's death, the house stands silent, leaving the poet begging strangers for love.

12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Why does the poet say that the house withdrew into silence?

Ans: The poet says so because her grandmother, who was the soul of the house, passed away. After her death, the house became completely empty, lonely, and silent.

Q2. What was the poet's condition regarding reading books in her childhood?

Ans: In her childhood, the poet was too young to read the books available in her grandmother's house. The books just lay there, and she found them cold and distant.

Q3. Why did the poet's blood turn cold like the moon?

Ans: Her blood turned cold like the moon due to a sudden shock of loneliness, grief, and the frightening silence of the house after her grandmother's death.

Q4. What does the poet see when she looks back at her grandmother's house?

Ans: When she looks back, she sees a dark, neglected house where snakes crawl among old books and the windows are covered with cold, freezing air.

Q5. What does the poet want to bring back from her grandmother's house?

Ans: The poet wants to bring back an armful of darkness or memories from that house to keep it behind her bedroom door like a comforting, loyal dog.

Q6. Why is the poet proud of her grandmother's house?

Ans: She is proud because that house was the only place where she lived with absolute dignity, felt completely safe, and received true, selfless love.



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Q7. How has the poet's life changed after leaving her grandmother's house?

Ans: After leaving the house, her life became emotionally empty. She lost her way and is now forced to beg at strangers' doors just to get a small amount of love.

Q8. What does the phrase "beg at strangers' doors" signify in the poem?

Ans: It signifies her deep emotional frustration and desperation. It shows that the modern world lacks genuine affection, forcing her to look for love in unfamiliar places.

Q9. How does Kamala Das describe the condition of the windows of the house?

Ans: She describes the windows as being completely blind and covered with frozen air, representing that the house has lost its warmth, vision, and life.

Q10. Who was Kamala Das, and what is she famous for in literature?

Ans: Kamala Das was a major Indian poet and novelist who wrote beautifully in both English and Malayalam. She is famous for her honest, autobiographical, and confessional poetry.

Q11. Why does the poet mention "snakes moving among books"?

Ans: She mentions this to create a vivid image of total neglect and decay. It highlights that the house has been abandoned for a long time, allowing wild creatures to take over.

Q12. What is the central theme of "My Grandmother's House"?

Ans: The central theme is nostalgia for childhood, the loss of pure unconditional love, and a sharp contrast between a warm past and a cold, lonely present.

35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'My Grandmother's House' is a touching autobiographical poem composed by: (A) Toru Dutt (B) Kamala Das (C) Sarojini Naidu (D) John Keats
2. Kamala Das was a distinguished Indian poet who wrote fluently in English and: (A) Hindi (B) Malayalam (C) Tamil (D) Bengali
3. Kamala Das was short-listed for the prestigious Nobel Prize for Literature in the year: (A) 1980 (B) 1984 (C) 1999 (D) 2005
4. Kamala Das was born in 1934 and passed away in the year: (A) 1998 (B) 2005 (C) 2009 (D) 2015
5. "There is a house now far away where once / I received _____ .": (A) money (B) love (C) scolding (D) education
6. The woman who lived in that nostalgic house and loved the poet was her: (A) mother (B) grandmother (C) aunt (D) sister
7. "The woman died, / The house withdrew into _____ ,": (A) darkness (B) silence (C) ruins (D) fire
8. After the death of the grandmother, snakes were seen moving among: (A) trees (B) books (C) beds



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(D) clothes

9. During her childhood in that house, the poet was too _____ to read books.: (A) lazy (B) young (C) smart (D) sick

10. "My blood turned cold like the _____ .": (A) ice (B) moon (C) water (D) stone

11. The poet often thinks of going back to that house to peer through its: (A) doors (B) blind windows (C) roofs (D) walls

12. The air around the grandmother's house is described as completely: (A) fresh (B) frozen / cold (C) hot (D) smoky

13. The poet wants to bring back an _____ of darkness from that house.: (A) bagful (B) armful (C) boxful (D) basketful

14. The poet wants to keep the memory of the old house behind her bedroom door like a: (A) cat (B) brooding dog (C) bird (D) guard

15. "You cannot believe, darling, / Can you, that I lived in such a house and was _____ ,": (A) sad (B) proud / loved (C) poor (D) angry

16. The poet addresses her companion or husband in the poem using the word: (A) sir (B) darling (C) friend (D) master

17. The poet confesses that she has completely lost her: (A) money (B) way / direction (C) books (D) clothes

18. "And beg now at _____ doors to receive love...": (A) friends' (B) strangers' (C) neighbors' (D) kings'

19. The poet begs for love at strangers' doors at least in small _____ .: (A) bags (B) change / measure (C) coins (D) boxes

20. The poem showcases a sharp contrast between her happy childhood and her painful: (A) school days (B) adult life (C) past (D) dreams

21. Kamala Das's poetry is globally categorized as highly: (A) political (B) confessional / personal (C) nature-oriented (D) war-centric

22. Her famous autobiography published in 1976 is titled: (A) Leaves of Grass (B) My Story (C) Distant Drum (D) Hind Swaraj

23. The phrase "blind eyes of windows" is an excellent example of: (A) Simile (B) Personification / Metaphor (C) Irony (D) Alliteration

24. The house withdrew into silence because its source of life and love was: (A) sold (B) dead / gone (C) broken (D) locked

25. The tone of the poem 'My Grandmother's House' is full of intense: (A) humor (B) nostalgia and melancholy (C) anger (D) bravery

26. The grandmother's love is described implicitly as selfless and: (A) conditional (B) unconditional / pure (C) expensive (D) temporary

27. The poet's blood turning cold represents a state of deep emotional: (A) joy (B) shock and



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depression (C) health (D) energy

28. Kamala Das also published works under the pen-name: (A) Madhavikutty (B) Kamala Markandaya (C) Toru (D) Savitri

29. The darkness of the old house is viewed by the poet as something: (A) terrifying (B) comforting / a souvenir (C) ugly (D) useless

30. The poem reveals the loneliness faced by women in modern, urban: (A) villages (B) societies / marriages (C) schools (D) fields

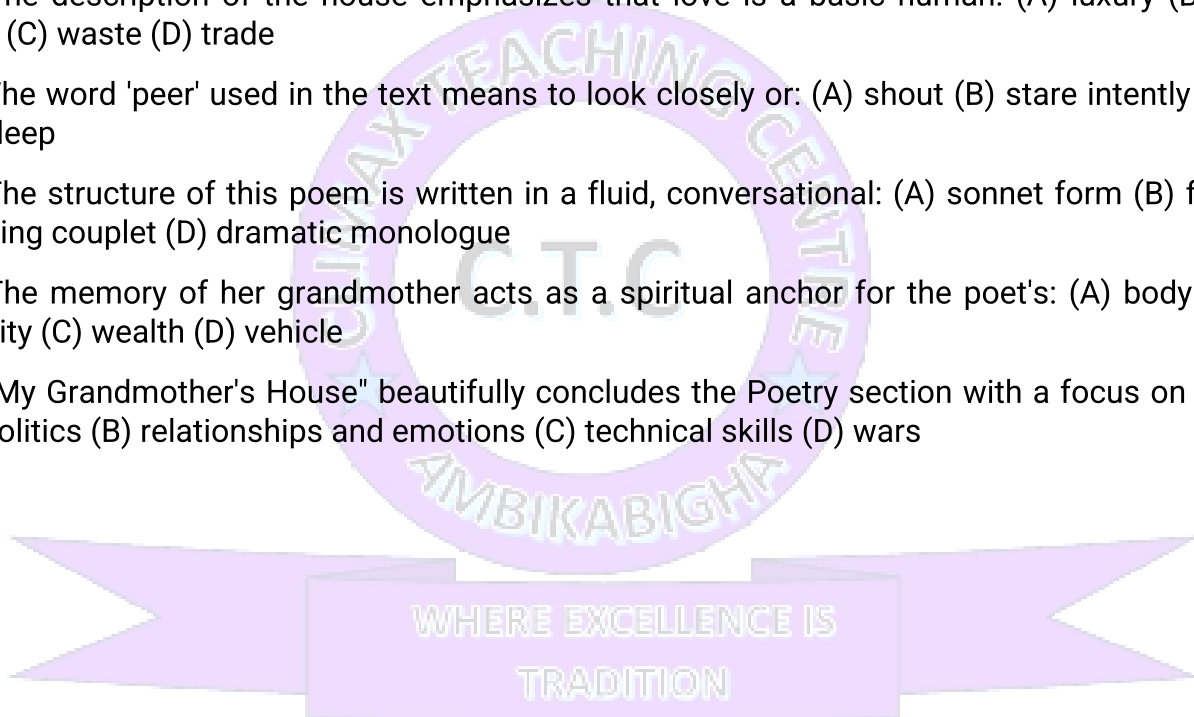
31. The description of the house emphasizes that love is a basic human: (A) luxury (B) necessity / need (C) waste (D) trade

32. The word 'peer' used in the text means to look closely or: (A) shout (B) stare intently (C) run away (D) sleep

33. The structure of this poem is written in a fluid, conversational: (A) sonnet form (B) free verse (C) rhyming couplet (D) dramatic monologue

34. The memory of her grandmother acts as a spiritual anchor for the poet's: (A) body (B) soul and identity (C) wealth (D) vehicle

35. "My Grandmother's House" beautifully concludes the Poetry section with a focus on deep human: (A) politics (B) relationships and emotions (C) technical skills (D) wars



SUJIT KUMAR

